



From Difference to Opportunity

➤ Rethinking AARP's Content Strategy





One Story, One Gap

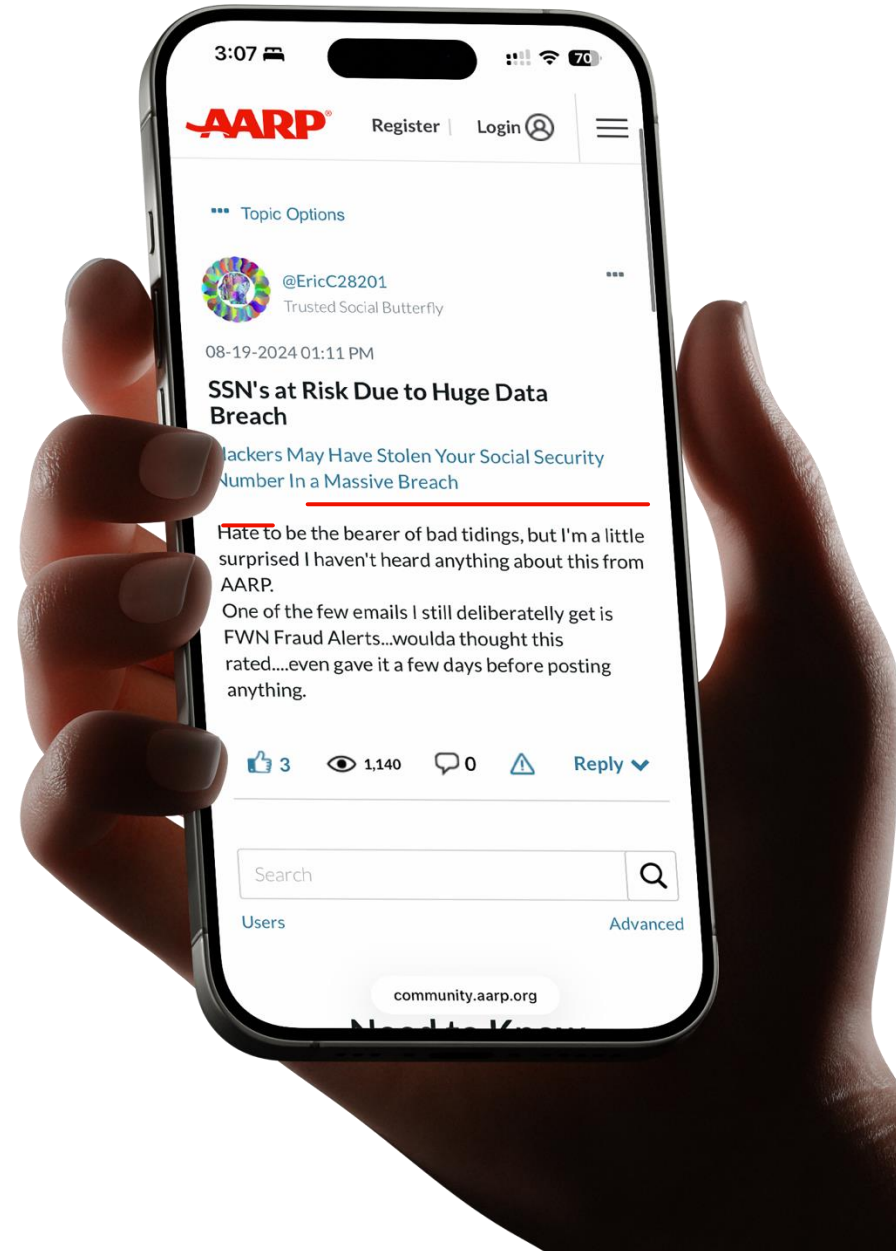
The New York Times
YOUR MONEY

What to Know About the Latest Social Security Number Breach

Hackers may have gained access to the private information of millions of people from a background check company called National Public Data. Should you be worried? We have some advice.

Aug 15, 2024

Aug 19, 2024





Key Recommendations



**Build Fraud into a Moat Through Respond Speed
+ AI Defense**



Build Climate & Weather Safety Hub



Expand financial content beyond benefits





Meet Our Team

Research Analytics Integration Modeling

Gimbiya Shehu Garba



Aastik Rajan



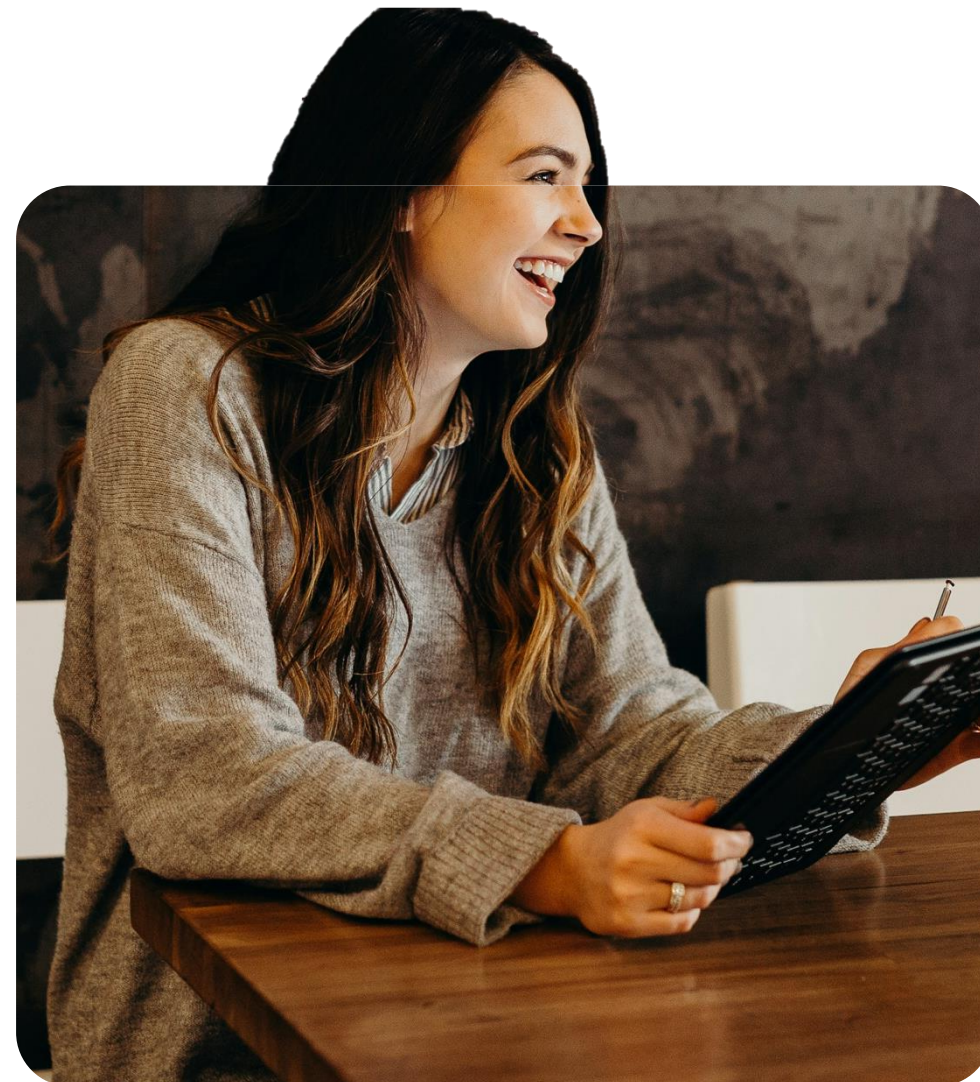
Elise Wang



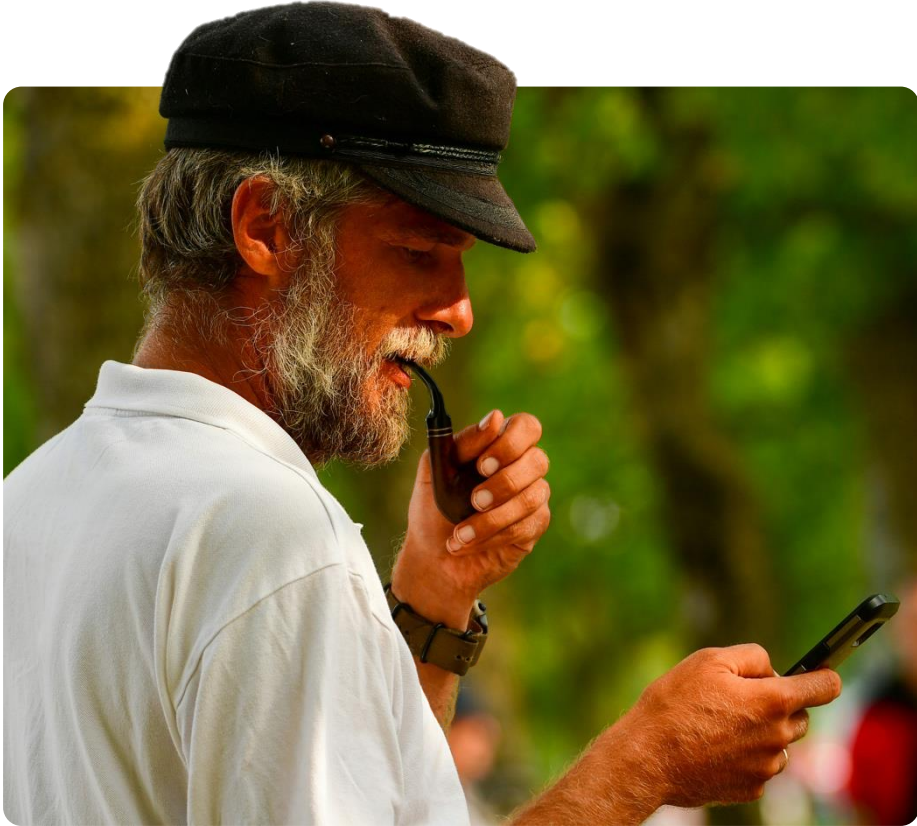
Jack Xu



Jade Xia



How we built our recommendation



1 Data Processing and Topic Modeling 

4 Final implementation direction 

2 Evidence structure 

Each recommendation is supported by:

- Long term analysis
- Short term analysis
- Literature review

3 Key findings 

Data-driven explanation of

- Content gaps
- Audience needs
- Strategic opportunities

Data Processing and Topic Modeling

1

Data Preparation &
Text Cleaning

5 Data Sources

Lowercasing

Stopword Removal

2

Model Selection &
Hyperparameter Tuning

BERTopic & LDA

Hyperparameter Tuning

Best Model Selection

3

Sentence Embeddings &
Similarity Matching

Article Embeddings

Cosine Similarity

Closest Match Retrieval

4

Content Gap
Identification

Potential Content Gaps

Undercovered Trending Topics

Section Level Analysis



Key Recommendation I

Build Fraud into a Moat Through Respond Speed + AI Defense 📢

✳️ Why It Matters? -Audience Research Support

77%



of 50+ worry they will personally become an AI fraud target

\$7.7B



in 60+ fraud losses in 2025 (59% increase from 2024)

34%



of older workers worry AI threatens jobs

\$352M



from 60+ alone (FBI's first-ever AI fraud category)



Key Recommendation I

Build Fraud into a Moat Through Respond Speed + AI Defense 📢

1 Fraud has the potential to be AARP's moat, but **speed** limits its impact

Short-term

Direction	Topic	Timing Gap
Lags	Climate / Science / Environment	14 days
Lags	Arts / Entertainment / Reviews	3 days
Lags	General Features / Mixed News	2 days
Lags	Fraud / Scams / Consumer Protection	2 days !
Lags	US Politics / Elections / White House	1 days

Long-term

Topic	Why It Matters for 50–65	Timing Gap
Fraud / Crypto Scams	AARP's own content moat — 94% share, yet response is late	33 months !
Home Insurance / Prices	Housing affordability crisis directly impacts retirees	22 months
Brain / Mental Health	Top search topic for 50–65 demographic	13 months
Social Security / COLA	AARP's #1 audience topic — still behind NYT	8 months
Wellness / Probiotics	Fast-growing health interest, up 120% velocity	11 months

* With short term fraud content coverage at 0%

Build Fraud into a Moat Through Respond Speed + AI Defense 📌

2 Tech/AI is a confirmed coverage **gap**

Short-term

Rank	Final Topic	Gap (BERTopic) (%)
1	Obituaries / Public Figures	0%
2	Public Figures / Legal Controversy	0%
3	Food / Recipes / Home	2%
4	General Features / Mixed News	5%
5	Big Tech / Digital / AI	5% !

Long-term

Topic	Gap (BERTopic) (%)	Gap (LDA)%
Climate / Environment	2.5%	0.0%
Public Safety / Crime	3.6%	0.1%
Entertainment / Culture	7–10%	0.1%
AI Industry / Digital	2.2%	0.0% !
Pets / Animals	—	0.0%



Key Recommendation I

Build Fraud into a Moat Through Respond Speed + AI Defense 📢

* How We Move Forward

77%



of 50+ worry they will personally become an AI fraud target

For 65+ (Primary)

- AI voice cloning & deepfake imposters
- Smart device privacy, crypto kiosks
- Weekly Scam Alert cadence

34%



of older workers worry AI threatens jobs

For 50-64 (Workplace)

- AI phishing & LinkedIn recruiter scams
- "AI advisor" investment scams
- Monthly Emerging Threats + Red Flag Drills



Key Recommendation II

Build Climate & Weather Safety Hub for Older Adults 🌞

* Why It Matters? -Audience Research Support

70%



of 65+ concerned about climate due to extreme heat

59%



of 50+ concerned about climate impact on their health

71%



of Katrina deaths were adults over 60

Only 6%



have talked to a healthcare provider about climate prep

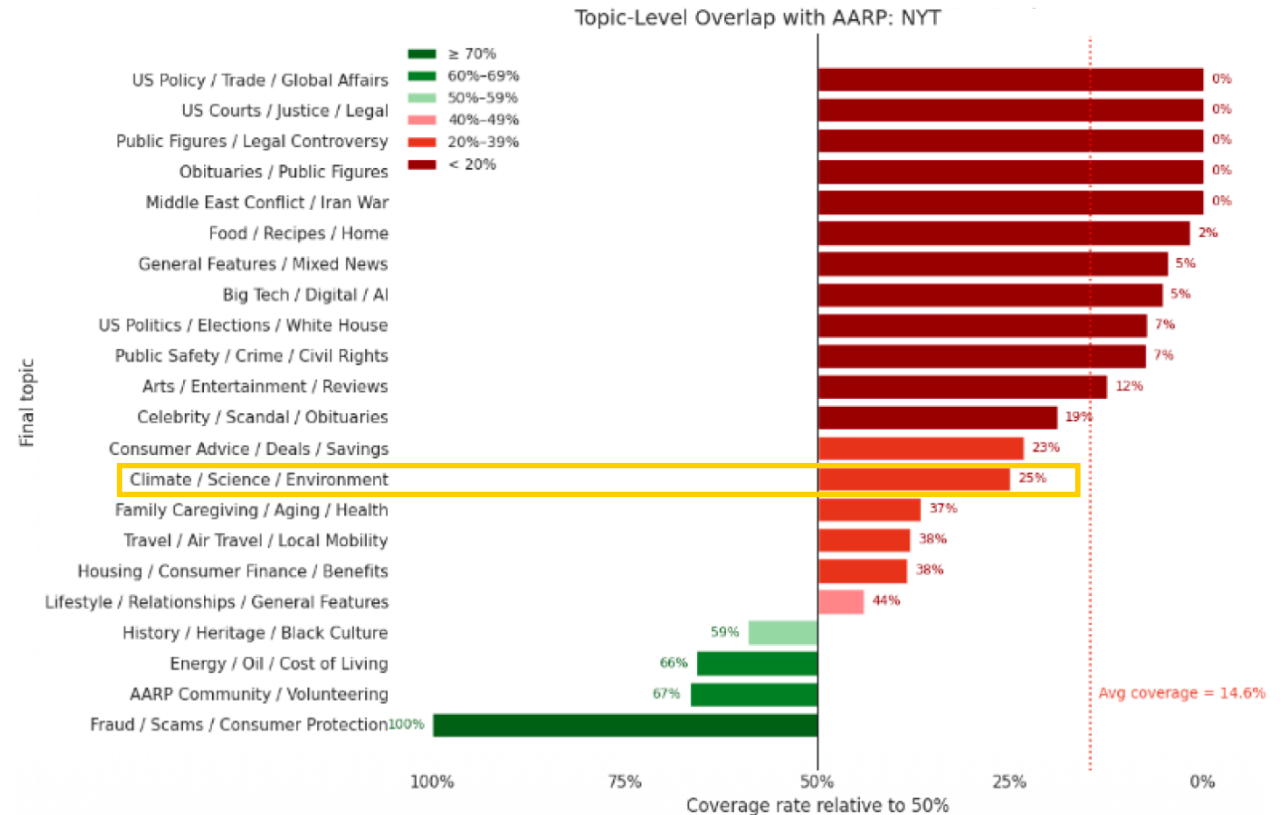
Build Climate & Weather Safety Hub for Older Adults 🌤️

1 Climate is a **consistent** coverage gap across all analyses

Short-term

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* Climate: AARP trails NYT by 1.3 percentage points





Key Recommendation II

Build Climate & Weather Safety Hub for Older Adults 🌤️

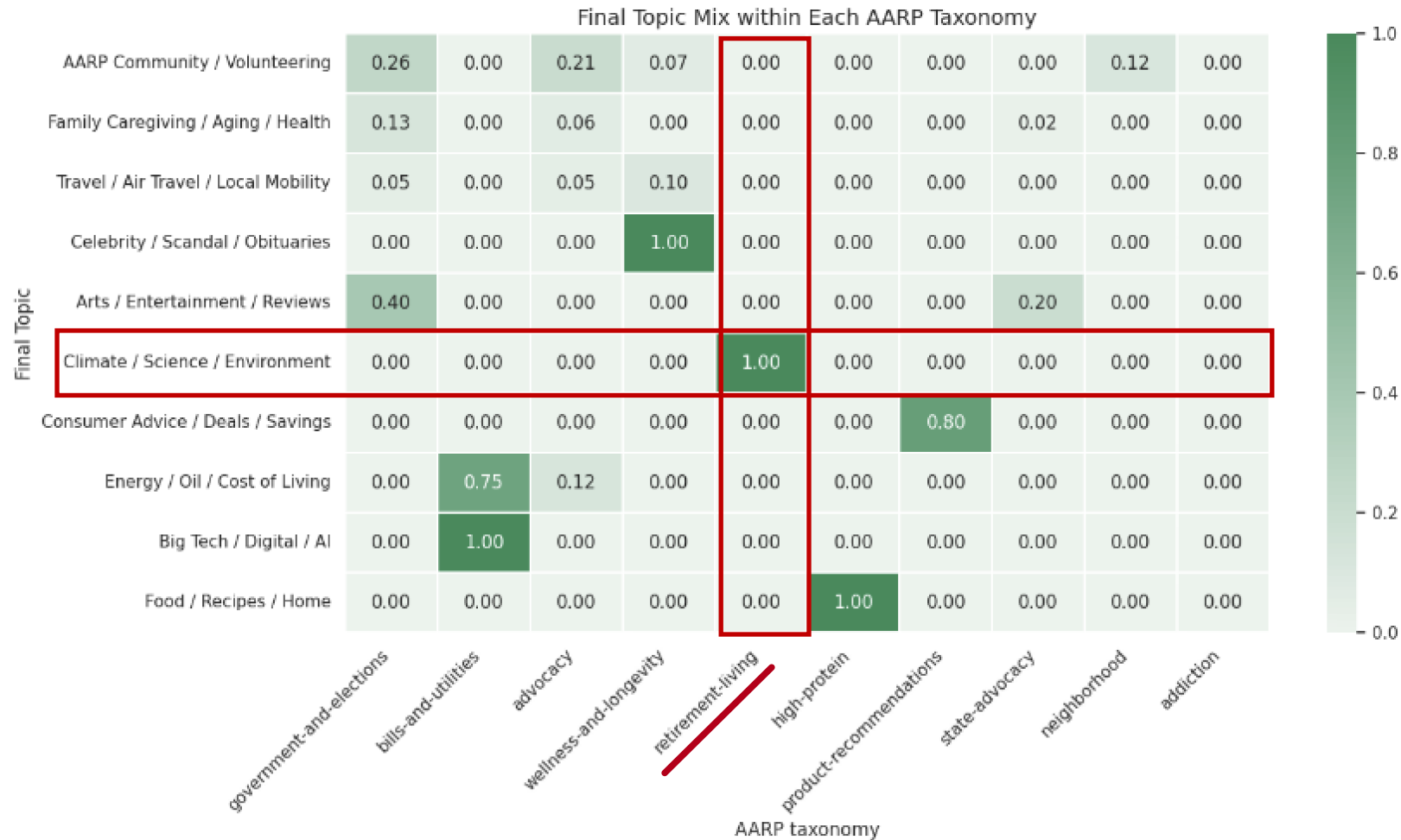
1 Climate is a **consistent** coverage gap across all analyses

Long-term

Topic	Keywords	BERTopic AARP%	LDA AARP%
Climate / Environment	climate change, warming, global, energy costs	2.5% !	0.0% !
Public Safety / Crime	police, officers, safety, crime, community	3.6%	0.1%
Entertainment / Culture	restaurant, documentary, grammy, arts, singer	7–10%	0.1%
Tech Industry / Digital	elon musk, twitter, tech, executive, company	2.2%	0.0%
Pets / Animals	dog, cat, golden, pet, owners, neighbors	—	0.0%

Build Climate & Weather Safety Hub for Older Adults 🌤️

2 Weather does not appear to be clearly defined as a **separate** taxonomy in AARP





Key Recommendation II

Build Climate & Weather Safety Hub for Older Adults 🌞

* How We Move Forward

70%



of 65+ concerned about climate due to extreme heat

For 65+ (Primary)

- Heat safety with chronic conditions
- Cooling centers, utility assistance by state
- Power outage prep & evacuation planning

59%



of 50+ concerned about climate impact on their health

For 50-64 (Secondary)

- Climate-aware retirement location scorecard
- Home insurance in climate risk zones
- Emergency prep for aging parents at distance



Key Recommendation III

Expand financial content beyond benefits

* Why It Matters? -Audience Research Support

81%

of Gen X worry they can't afford their desired retirement lifestyle



34%

of 65+ households are cost-burdened



28%

of Gen X (55-60) extremely concerned about income lasting vs only 14% of Boomers



45%

of women 50-64 can't afford healthcare



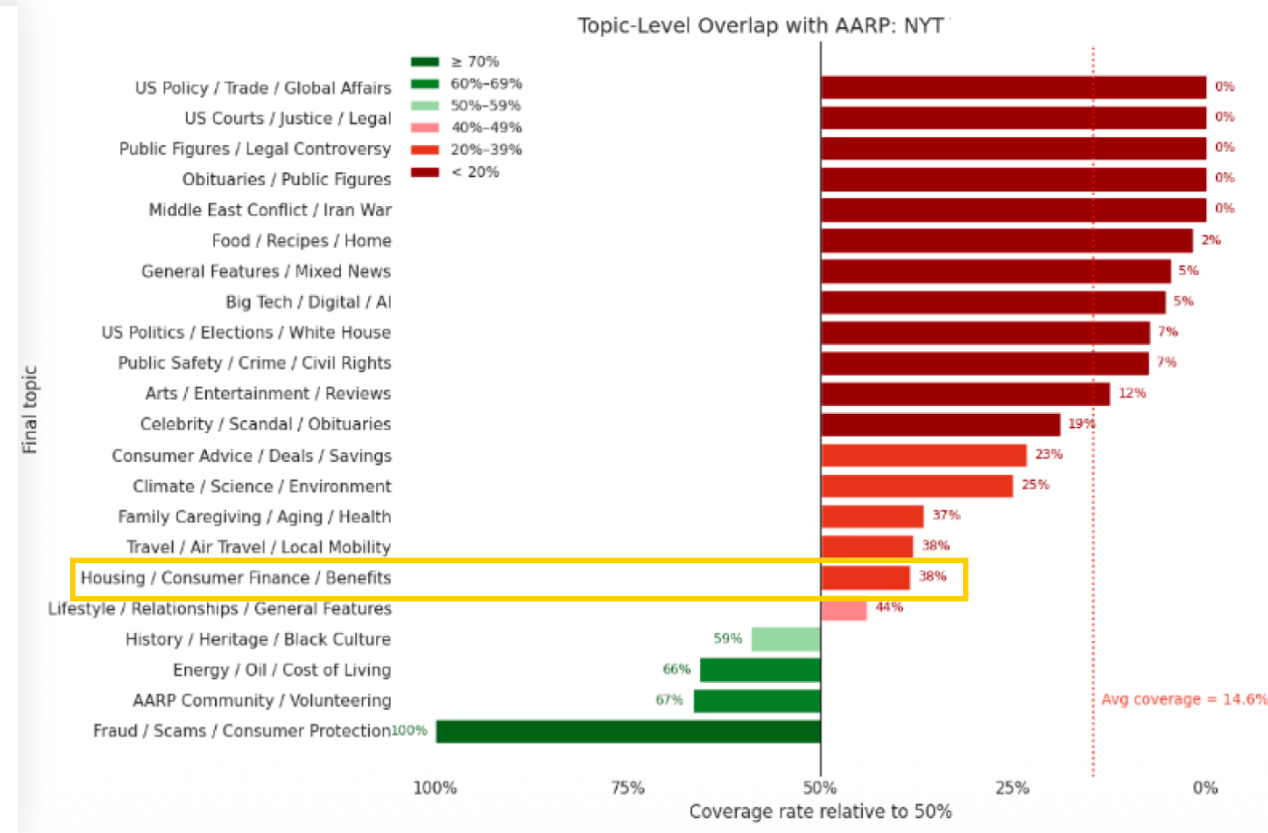
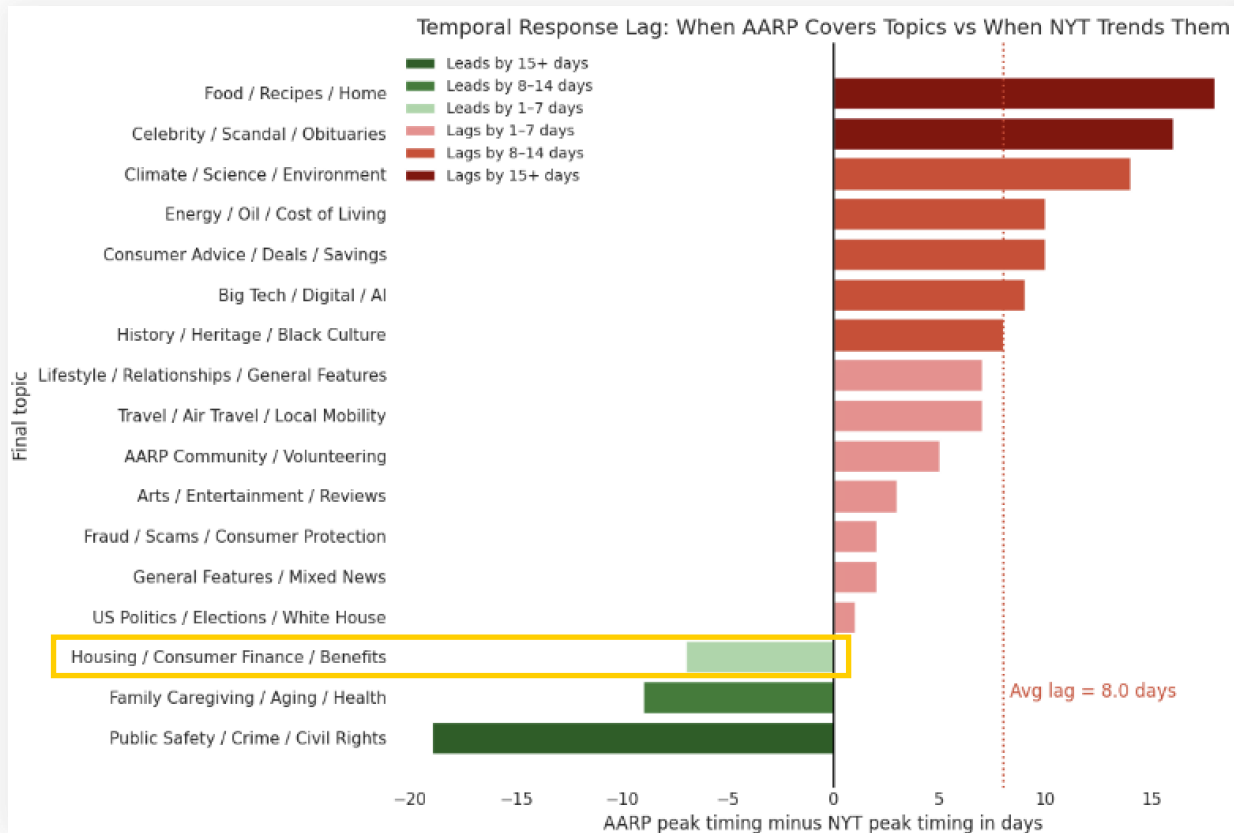


Key Recommendation III

Expand financial content beyond benefits 🐼

1 Finance: shows early coverage, though reader-interest alignment appears limited

Short-term





Key Recommendation III

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Long-term

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Key Recommendation III

Expand financial content beyond benefits

* How We Move Forward



81%

of Gen X worry they can't afford their desired retirement lifestyle

For 50+ (Gen X)

- Healthcare affordability for Adults Aged 50+
- Gen X debt triage & pension catch-up
- Sandwich-generation financial triage



34%

of 65+ households are cost-burdened

For 65+ (Fixed Income)

- Monthly SS COLA Brief, Home Insurance
- Rent assistance, property tax deferral
- Widowhood financial transition



Conclusion

Implementation*

Short-Term Strategy

0 – 3 months

- Pilot Fraud Speed (Rec 1)
- Editorial trigger for AI scam variants



Long-Term Strategy

3 – 12 months

- Build Climate Safety Hub (Rec 2)
- Reframe Money section (Rec 3)



Beyond the Three

"Never Just One" Loneliness as 50–64 growth entry point — peaks at **45–49 (49%)**

CONNECTION 01

Buddy Match

Peer matching by life stage, not age

- Cohorts by transition: empty-nest, caregiving, divorce
- Mobile-first 1:1 and small-group formats

CARE 02

The 3pm Call

A daily ritual for solo households

- Opt-in daily check-in: wellness signal + safety net
- Volunteer-staffed, AARP-coordinated

VOICE 03

Love & Relationships Podcast

Honest 50+ stories, on the record

- Dating at 58, love after loss, overdue conversations
- Companion segment "Tea": entertainment, culture, light takes



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Appendix: Additional Analysis(Short-term)

AARP's main short-term opportunity: expanding coverage in high-visibility news and public-affairs topics

Rank	Topic	NYT Articles	AARP Articles	Gap	Gap Severity
1	Arts / Entertainment / Reviews	385 (12.5%)	5 (2.1%)	-10.3%	CRITICAL !
2	General Features / Mixed News	306 (9.9%)	1 (0.4%)	-9.5%	HIGH !
3	Public Safety / Crime / Civil Rights	242 (7.8%)	2 (0.9%)	-7.0%	HIGH !
4	Middle East Conflict / Iran War	193 (6.2%)	0 (0.0%)	-6.2%	HIGH !
5	Obituaries / Public Figures	129 (4.2%)	0 (0.0%)	-4.2%	MODERATE !
6	US Policy / Trade / Global Affairs	124 (4.0%)	0 (0.0%)	-4.0%	MODERATE !
7	US Courts / Justice / Legal	111 (3.6%)	0 (0.0%)	-3.6%	MODERATE !
8	US Politics / Elections / White House	123 (4.0%)	1 (0.4%)	-3.6%	MODERATE !
9	Big Tech / Digital / AI	114 (3.7%)	1 (0.4%)	-3.3%	MODERATE !
10	Public Figures / Legal Controversy	99 (3.2%)	0 (0.0%)	-3.2%	MODERATE !
11	Food / Recipes / Home	58 (1.9%)	1 (0.4%)	-1.4%	LOW
12	Energy / Oil / Cost of Living	146 (4.7%)	8 (3.4%)	-1.3%	LOW
13	Climate / Science / Environment	52 (1.7%)	1 (0.4%)	-1.3%	LOW





Appendix: Additional Analysis(Long-term)

NYT has stronger long-term coverage in key public and hard news topics where AARP has limited presence

Topic (LDA)	Keywords	NYT Dominance
Tick-borne Disease / Lyme	tick, borne, ticks, lyme, conversion, mdma	100% !
Canada / International	canada, canadian, wars, senegal, ottawa	100% !
NYC Housing / Rent	building, apartment, manhattan, rent, board	100% !
Extreme Weather	heat, hot, cold, wave, degrees, temperatures	100% !

Age-group coverage appears more concentrated among ages 60–69, while 70+ receives less consistent representation

Cluster	Dominant Cohort (AARP)	Senior (70+) in AARP	Senior in NYT
Social Role	Middle 60–69 (100–480 hits)	Low (0–110 hits)	Low
Health	Younger $\approx$ Middle	Negative throughout (–100 to +20)	Dominant from 2024 (80–120 hits)
Space	Younger 50–59 (50–325 hits)	Lowest (0–55 hits)	Low
Cognitive	No dominant cohort	Parity with other cohorts	Low